

Why don't AI cooling centers use sea water?

Posted by u/Silly_Foot_2657 • 0 points • 9 comments

Since the water they use doesn't have to be drinkable, why not use sea water which is, very much, infinite? If it has to do with salt content damaging equipment, can't they filter the salt out first?

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-04 11:44 UTC

[removed]

u/Mysterious_Curve3163 • 1 points • 2026-03-03 22:54 UTC

>If it has to do with salt content damaging equipment, can't they filter the salt out first?

desalination is very expensive

u/TehNolz • 1 points • 2026-03-03 22:44 UTC

They could, but desalinating water is rather expensive. Cheaper to just use fresh water, so that's what they go for.

u/generic_redditor_71 • 2 points • 2026-03-03 22:43 UTC

Desalinating sea water is extremely expensive and the water consumption of data centers isn't actually a relevant problem.

u/Silly_Foot_2657 • 1 points • 2026-03-03 22:45 UTC

But I always hear about how AI is destroying the environment and makes formerly-pure water unsuitable for human consumption... I'm just a bit confused since it's the argument most commonly brought against AI.

u/generic_redditor_71 • 1 points • 2026-03-03 22:55 UTC

Energy use of datacenters is a problem, but the water thing is pretty much just made up. Someone wrote a ragebait article with fake math and Reddit gobbled it up because Reddit is full of morons who will believe anything if it makes it easier to be mad at whoever they hate this week.

u/notatmycompute • 3 points • 2026-03-03 22:42 UTC

>If it has to do with salt content damaging equipment, can't they filter the salt out first?

Desalination is very expensive and energy hungry.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-16 18:21 UTC

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u/Ruval • 1 points • 2026-03-03 23:50 UTC

Also salt is had for metal

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-03 22:40 UTC

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u/ForScale • 1 points • 2026-03-03 22:39 UTC

They do, homie.